

D184

Standards-Based Assessment

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A sixth-grade team that meets every Tuesday unpacks the standard: “Compare and contrast two texts on the same topic.” The team’s grade-level books are brand new. Which learning target best matches the standard?

- A. “I can name the topic of a text.”
- B. “I can summarize one text.”
- C. “I can read our new books.”
- D. “I can explain how two texts on one topic are alike and different.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A test item asks students to list the three branches of government. Which standard does it best match?

- A. “Any civics standard, since the topic matches.”
- B. “Evaluate how checks and balances limit power.”
- C. “Identify the three branches of government.”
- D. “Analyze a court case’s effect on law.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A math department, whose chair recently earned a doctorate, must choose which standards to assess most deeply. One standard, on fractions, is used in science and needed for algebra next year. Another fills 40 textbook pages but is rarely used later. Which should be a priority standard?

- A. Both equally, since all standards must be assessed the same way.
- B. The fractions standard, because it has leverage and readiness value.
- C. The 40-page standard, since it takes the most time in the book.
- D. Whichever is easiest to test.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

On a 4-point proficiency scale, a student in a class of 31 correctly solves all the simpler vocabulary and recall questions but cannot yet do the target task of analyzing an author's argument without help. The student has perfect attendance. What score fits?

- A. 3
- B. 2
- C. 4, for perfect attendance.
- D. 1

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's work goes beyond the target by applying the skill to a new, more complex situation not taught in class. What score is this on a 4-point scale?

- A. 100%
- B. 3
- C. 4
- D. 2

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A standard says students will “analyze how a setting shapes a story's conflict.” A teacher, using her favorite novel from college, writes: “Where does the story take place?” What is wrong with the item?

- A. Nothing; it is about setting, so it aligns.
- B. The novel is the wrong choice.
- C. It asks for recall, while the standard requires analysis.
- D. It should ask students to create a new story.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A student turns in a lab report two days late because of a family trip to a national park. The report fully meets the standard for designing a controlled experiment. The teacher's policy deducts one level per late day. Under standards-based grading, what should the proficiency score reflect?

- A. The quality of the work against the standard, with lateness reported separately.
- B. Full credit only because the trip was educational.
- C. A zero until a reason is proven.
- D. Two levels lower for two late days.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher adds 1 point to proficiency scores for students who bring supplies every day. What problem does this create?

- A. None, since rewarding good habits is always helpful.
- B. It lowers scores for prepared students.
- C. It makes the rubric harder to read.
- D. The score no longer shows only what the student knows and can do.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

On one standard, a student in a popular robotics elective scored 1, 2, 3, and 3 on a 4-point scale across a six-week unit. What proficiency level should be reported?

- A. 3
- B. 6
- C. 1
- D. 2.25

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student scored 4 on an easy early quiz, then 2, 2, and 2 on later full assessments of the same standard. What should be reported?

- A.** 4
- B.** 2.5
- C.** The highest score ever earned.
- D.** 2

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Four fifth-grade teachers, all trained at the same university, use one rubric for opinion writing. Scores for similar essays vary from 2 to 4 across rooms. The school just adopted a new report card. What should the team do?

- A.** Score the same sample essays together and discuss differences until they agree.
- B.** Wait until the new report card settles in.
- C.** Average the four teachers' scores for each student.
- D.** Rewrite the rubric with more categories.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A teacher with a large, sunny classroom wants to know by the end of today's lesson which students still confuse area and perimeter, so she can regroup them tomorrow. Which assessment fits?

- A.** The end-of-year state test.
- B.** A formative exit ticket.
- C.** No assessment, since observation is always enough.
- D.** A quarterly district interim test.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A sixth-grade team ~~that meets every Tuesday~~ unpacks the standard: "Compare and contrast two texts on the same topic." ~~The team's grade-level books are brand new.~~ Which learning target best matches the standard?

Target word: target that keeps the verb **Decides:** The verbs are compare and contrast.

A	Dropped element	Drops the compare-and-contrast skill.
B	Adjacent category	A different skill with only one text.
C	Camouflage	Centers on the materials, not the standard.
D	Correct	Keeps both the skill (compare/contrast) and the content.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A test item asks students to list the three branches of government. Which standard does it best match?

Target word: work backward from item to standard **Decides:** Listing is recall.

A	Absolute language	Topic match alone is not alignment.
B	Inverted operation	Requires judgment, far above listing.
C	Correct	Identify matches the recall demand of listing.
D	Confusion set	Analysis, not recall.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A math department, ~~whose chair recently earned a doctorate,~~ must choose which standards to assess most deeply. One standard, on fractions, is used in science and needed for algebra next year. Another fills 40 textbook pages but is rarely used later. Which should be a priority standard?

Target word: priority criteria **Decides:** Leverage and readiness.

A	Absolute language	Prioritizing means some get deeper assessment.
B	Correct	Used across subjects and needed next year.
C	Wrong stem number	Page count is not a priority criterion.
D	Adjacent category	Ease of testing is not endurance, leverage, or readiness.

4. Answer B Concept 3

On a 4-point proficiency scale, a student ~~in a class of 31~~ correctly solves all the simpler vocabulary and recall questions but cannot yet do the target task of analyzing an author's argument without help. ~~The student has perfect attendance.~~ What score fits?

Target word: place on the scale **Decides:** Masters simpler content but not the target.

A	Confusion set	3 requires the target task independently.
B	Correct	Score 2 = simpler foundational content without the target.
C	Camouflage	Attendance is not evidence of proficiency.
D	Inverted operation	1 is partial success only with help, even on simpler content.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A student's work goes beyond the target by applying the skill to a new, more complex situation not taught in class. What score is this on a 4-point scale?

Target word: score for beyond-target work **Decides:** Beyond the target = 4.

A	Confusion set	Scales are levels, not percentages.
B	Adjacent category	3 is meeting the target.
C	Correct	4 means going beyond the grade-level target.
D	Inverted operation	2 is below the target.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A standard says students will “analyze how a setting shapes a story's conflict.” A teacher, ~~using her favorite novel from college~~, writes: “Where does the story take place?” What is wrong with the item?

Target word: alignment problem **Decides:** The standard asks for analysis; the item asks for recall.

A	Absolute language	Topic match is not level match.
B	Camouflage	Text choice is not the alignment issue.
C	Correct	Thinking level does not match.
D	Adjacent category	Creating is a different level from analyzing.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A student turns in a lab report two days late ~~because of a family trip to a national park~~. The report fully meets the standard for designing a controlled experiment. The teacher's policy deducts one level per late day. Under standards-based grading, what should the proficiency score reflect?

Target word: what the score reports **Decides:** The work meets the standard.

A	Correct	Achievement and behavior are reported apart.
B	Camouflage	The trip is not the reason; the work quality is.
C	Absolute language	Zero says nothing about what the student knows.
D	Wrong stem number	Penalizes behavior in the achievement score.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A teacher adds 1 point to proficiency scores for students who bring supplies every day. What problem does this create?

Target word: effect of a bonus, reversed from a penalty **Decides:** Behavior raises an achievement score.

A	Absolute language	Habits can be rewarded, but in a separate report.
B	Inverted operation	It raises, not lowers, their scores.
C	Adjacent category	The issue is meaning, not readability.
D	Correct	Mixing behavior into achievement distorts the report.

9. Answer A Concept 6

On one standard, a student in a popular robotics elective scored 1, 2, 3, and 3 on a 4-point scale across a six-week unit. What proficiency level should be reported?

Target word: which score to report **Decides:** The most recent, consistent evidence is 3.

A	Correct	The latest two scores consistently show 3.
B	Camouflage	The unit length, not a score.
C	Wrong stem number	The first score, not current learning.
D	Inverted operation	Averaging lets early attempts pull down current mastery.

10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A student scored 4 on an easy early quiz, then 2, 2, and 2 on later full assessments of the same standard. What should be reported?

Target word: rule applied when scores fall **Decides:** Most recent consistent evidence is 2.

A	Wrong stem number	One early score on easier work.
B	Inverted operation	Averages instead of using recent consistent evidence.
C	Absolute language	Recency and consistency, not the best single score.
D	Correct	The recent, consistent evidence shows 2.

11. Answer A Concept 7

Four fifth-grade teachers, all trained at the same university, use one rubric for opinion writing. Scores for similar essays vary from 2 to 4 across rooms. The school just adopted a new report card. What should the team do?

Target word: fix inconsistent scoring **Decides:** Scores vary for similar work.

A	Correct	Calibration builds shared meaning for each level.
B	Camouflage	The report card does not fix scoring.
C	Inverted operation	Averaging hides the disagreement.
D	Adjacent category	A new rubric does not guarantee shared scoring.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A teacher with a large, sunny classroom wants to know by the end of today's lesson which students still confuse area and perimeter, so she can regroup them tomorrow. Which assessment fits?

Target word: match purpose to type **Decides:** Quick daily check to guide teaching.

A	Confusion set	Summative, and too late to guide tomorrow.
B	Correct	Quick evidence to adjust tomorrow's teaching.
C	Absolute language	A quick check gives each student's evidence.
D	Adjacent category	Tracks progress across units, not today's lesson.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Unpacking a standard	The verbs in a standard name the skill and thinking level to assess; the nouns name the content. Assess both at the level the verb demands.	Assessing the topic (nouns) while ignoring what students must do with it (verbs).	A standard's wording and a proposed task or learning target.
2	Priority (power) standards	Choose standards to assess deeply by endurance (value beyond the test), leverage (use across subjects), and readiness (needed for the next level).	Prioritizing whatever takes the most pages in the textbook or is easiest to test.	Deciding which of many standards get the most assessment time.
3	Proficiency scales	On a typical 4-point scale, 3 is the target standard, 2 is the simpler foundational content, 4 goes beyond the target, and 1 is partial success with help.	Treating 4 as the grade-level goal, or treating the scale like percentages.	A description of student work and a scale score to assign.
4	Cognitive-level alignment	An item is aligned only if it asks for the same thinking level as the standard (for example, recall vs. analyze vs. create).	Calling any item on the right topic aligned.	A standard verb like analyze or evaluate next to a recall item.
5	Separate achievement from behavior	Standards-based grades report what students know and can do; effort, lateness, and participation are reported separately.	Lowering a proficiency score for late work or missing homework.	A penalty or bonus not tied to the standard.
6	Most recent, consistent evidence	Report proficiency from the most recent consistent evidence of learning, not an average that includes early attempts.	Averaging all scores so early struggles drag down later mastery.	A series of scores on one standard that rise over time.
7	Scoring reliability through calibration	Teachers score the same samples against the scale and discuss differences until they agree, so a 3 means the same thing in every room.	Assuming a clear rubric alone makes scoring consistent.	Different teachers giving different scores to similar work.
8	A balanced assessment system	Formative checks guide daily teaching, interim or common assessments track progress across units, and summative assessments certify learning at the end.	Using one big test for every purpose.	An assessment purpose to match to an assessment type.

Course scope (public description): Standards-Based Assessment teaches candidates how to unpack academic standards to determine the essential learnings within the standards that should be assessed. This course teaches candidates how to determine, based on academic standards, which topics should be assessed and how to use proficiency statements to create and score standards-based assessments. This course also prepares students to analyze assessment data and develop a holistic assessment system for a specific subject and grade level. Differentiated Instruction is a prerequisite for this course.